

Modulation with accidentals

Modulation may be indicated with accidentals rather than with a new key signature, especially if the modulation is between two closely related keys, and if the music will soon return to its original key. Double bar lines do not occur in such instances.

▽ To the dominant

This melody moves from G major to the key a fifth higher (D major), which is called the dominant.

G major

C = 4th note of the G major scale

D major

▽ To the subdominant

Here the melody moves from C major to the key a fourth higher (F major), which is called the subdominant.

C major

B = 7th note of the C major scale

F major

Flattened to become the 4th note of the F major scale

▽ From relative major to relative minor

The melody here moves from F major to its relative minor, D minor, by sharpening the 5th note of the F major scale.

F major

C = 5th note of the F major scale

D minor

Sharpened to become the 7th note of the D harmonic minor scale

▽ From relative minor to relative major

Here the melody moves from B minor to its relative major, D major, no longer sharpening the 7th note of the B harmonic minor scale.

B minor

A# = 7th note of the B harmonic minor scale

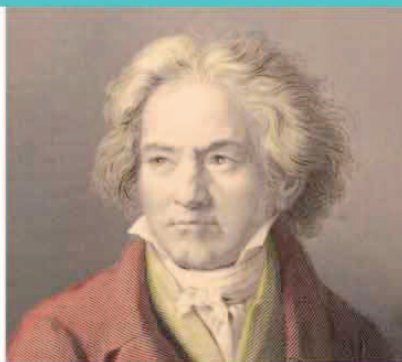
D major

A# = 5th note of the D major scale

REAL WORLD

Ludwig van Beethoven

The German composer Ludwig van Beethoven (1770–1827) is one of the most important figures in the transition between Classical and Romantic music. His use of keys and harmony was very innovative for a composer of his time. A striking example of this is the modulations in "By the Brook" from the *Pastoral Symphony*. The music starts and ends in B♭ major, but modulates to keys such as G major, E♭ major, and C♭ major.



In **American marching band music**, if the march starts in a **major key**, the music often **modulates** to the **subdominant for the trio section**. If it starts in a **minor key**, it often **modulates to the relative major**.